

A GOOD MAN
Steven Lane Shipley Service
4/18/19

I have known Mr. Shipley during the time he has taught at BETA here at CT Houston. In that time, I have found him to be:

- A devout Christian...
- Very dedicated to his daughters Taylor and Athena (Ath-a-na) and his son Alex...
- Devoted to educating the next generation...
- Kind, courteous, and always very respectful...

When I was asked to say a few words at this memorial service I immediately thought of a little-known verse tucked away in Luke 23. The 23rd chapter of Luke records the crucifixion of Jesus. Simon Peter as well as all the other disciples failed to stand with Jesus in His greatest hour of trial. Before going to Pilates judgment hall Jesus predicted that Simon Peter would deny him, an accusation that Peter

vehemently denied. All of us know about Peter's denial of Jesus but Dr. Luke makes us aware that not only did Peter deny Jesus; all the other disciples *"forsook Him and fled"*.

While Jesus is left all alone to die on the cross, we are introduced to a man whose name has never been in lights, but whose deeds exceed the deeds of the disciples by a long shot. Luke 23:50-53 (NKJV) *"Now behold, there was a man named Joseph, a council member, a good and just man.⁵¹ He had not consented to their decision and deed. He was from Arimathea, a city of the Jews, who himself was also waiting for the kingdom of God.⁵² This man went to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus.⁵³ Then he took it down, wrapped it in linen, and laid it in a tomb that was hewn out of the rock, where no one had ever lain before."*

This Scripture gives us a glimpse into the life of this *"good man."*

- His name was Joseph

- He lived in Arimathea - ***"A city of the Jews."***
- He was a man who had distinguished himself as a leader - ***"He was a council member."***
- He was respected by his peers - Places of leadership are reserved for people who secure the respect of peers and superiors.
- He did not agree with the decision to convict and crucify Jesus - ***"He had not consented to their decisions and deeds."***
- He was a believer - ***"He was waiting for the Kingdom of God."***
- He was a doer of good deeds - This man went to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus. ***"Then he took it down, wrapped it in linen, and laid it in a tomb that was hewn out of the rock, where no one had ever lain before."*** Mr. Shipley was a doer of good deeds; he loved fixing mechanical things and helping people. (He is probably working on a chariot in heaven right now, or

showing some children around the New Jerusalem)

- He was a good man - *"Now behold there was a man named Joseph, a Council member, a good and just man."*

In a world where good men are growing scarcer by the day, Mr. Shipley was a good man. When I read this Scripture I must ask myself the question, how does one become a good man?

By looking at Joseph's life and Mr. Shipley's life I have come to the following conclusion; one does not become a good man by winning a popularity contest or an election; one becomes known as a good man by the sum total of the choices he makes in life.

I. MR. SHIPLEY WAS A GOOD CITIZEN...

Joseph was a man who gave of himself and served the greater good with a willing heart. He was serving on the council!

Mr. Shipley devoted himself to the children of this neighborhood. CT Church assisted Mrs. Andrews in getting a charter for one reason... To transform this community through education and Mr. Shipley and all his peers have helped to accomplish that goal. Hundreds of lives are being transformed through their commitment to the scholars in this neighborhood.

Mr. Shipley was a good man!

II. MR. SHIPLEY WAS A GOOD CHRISTIAN...

Joseph made a choice to follow Jesus when as far as we know, he was the only one on the council who made this decision. He made this decision when public sentiment was running very high in the opposite direction.

Mr. Shipley loved Jesus and made a lifetime commitment to serving him.

Some of you probably don't know this but Mr. Shipley was a preacher!

- He preached his first sermon at 16 years of age...
- He pastored a church in Lamesa TX...
- He led groups of men in the weekend spiritual emphasis called Road to Emmaus...

On Saturday morning Mr. Shipley's street turned to gold.

Mr. Shipley was a good man!

III. MR. SHIPLEY WAS A GOOD STUDENT OF THE BIBLE...

Joseph would not have been on the Council unless he understood civil and religious complexities!

The creed Mr. Shipley decided to live by is the Word of God. The Fruit of the Spirit, which

operated so freely through his actions,
characterized Mr. Shipley's life:

- Love...
- Joy...
- Peace...
- Patience...
- Goodness...
- Kindness...
- Faithfulness...
- Gentleness...

His family has many good memories, about this good man and this is because he chose to allow his life to be regulated by the boundaries of the Word of God!

He loved:

- Baseball...
- Basketball...
- Fishing... (Fishing was the main reason he moved to this area)

Mr. Shipley looked for ways to help others. He had feet of clay, but his path was mapped according to the Bible.

Mr. Shipley was a good man!

IV. MR. SHIPLEY WAS A GOOD FATHER...

Mr. Shipley loved his daughters Taylor and Athena (Ath-a-na) and his son Alex and taught them many good life lessons:

- He taught them about the things of God...
- He taught them to have a good work ethic...
(Taylor about to graduate High School – Athena (Ath-a-na) is in college to work in Cardiology - Alex is in the Air Force)
- He taught them that life is not a spectator sport; it is a full contact sport...
- He taught them to stand on principle...

Mr. Shipley was a good man.

CONCLUSION:

Mr. Shipley never considered failure. He believed that God would give him the strength and ability to get the job done. He was a good man, and because of his confidence in his standing and relationship with God, he was comfortable with who he was, and where he was. He was courageous until the very end.

The one thing Mr. Shipley would want me to do is to give each of you an opportunity to accept Christ. If you do not know Jesus today, this entire congregation is going to repeat a prayer after me in just a moment. If you will repeat the prayer and mean it in your heart, you can be saved. Please bow your heads and everyone repeat this prayer after me.

Dear Lord Jesus. I admit I am a sinner and cannot save myself. I am sorry for every sin I have ever committed. Please forgive me of my sins. I accept your blood sacrifice as more than enough to cover all of my sins. I accept you and declare that Jesus is now Lord of my life. I will

serve you all the days of my life. I ask all these things in Jesus name, Amen.